

Mp10 AutoTasks — Administrator's Guide

Backups, electronic remittances, and automated reports

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1 About this guide

Mp10 includes a background service called **AutoTasks**. It runs unattended on your server and takes care of work that would otherwise have to be done by hand every day:

- taking a **backup** of your data on a schedule you choose,
- reading **electronic remittances** (payment advices) that you download from your insurers, and posting them into Mp10, and
- running **reports** on a schedule and e-mailing them to whoever needs them.

This guide is for the person who administers Mp10 at the practice. It does not assume you are a programmer. It does assume you can open the **Admin10** module and that you know where your practice keeps its shared folders.

Anything in this guide that must be done by whoever installed Mp10 (your IT person or your reseller) is marked **IT task**.

A note on wording. Throughout this guide, *setting* means an entry in the Mp10 System Registry — not the Windows registry. They are unrelated. Nothing in this guide requires you to open Windows' own registry editor.

2 How AutoTasks works

AutoTasks runs as a Windows service on your Mp10 server. Once started it wakes up at a fixed interval, checks whether there is anything to do, does it, and goes back to sleep.

Setting	Section	Default	What it does
RUN_EVERY_N_SECONDS	AUTOTASKS	120	How often the service wakes up, in seconds

Two consequences worth understanding, because they explain most “why hasn’t it happened yet?” questions:

- **Nothing happens instantly.** If you drop a file into a folder, AutoTasks picks it up on its next wake-up — up to two minutes later by default.
- **Scheduled work fires on the first wake-up at or after the time you set**, not exactly on the second.

2.1 The log file

AutoTasks writes everything it does to a log file sitting next to the service program, named after it with a .out extension. On a typical install:

C:\Mp10\AutoTasks.out

This file is the single most useful thing to look at when something has not happened. It is plain text — open it with Notepad. Every line is stamped with the date and time.

The log is capped so it cannot fill the disk:

Setting	Section	Default	What it does
MAXIMUM_LOG_FILE_SIZE	GENERAL	8192	Largest log size in KB before it is trimmed

3 Where settings live: the System Registry

All three capabilities in this guide are switched on and configured in one place: **Admin10** → **Global System Registry**.

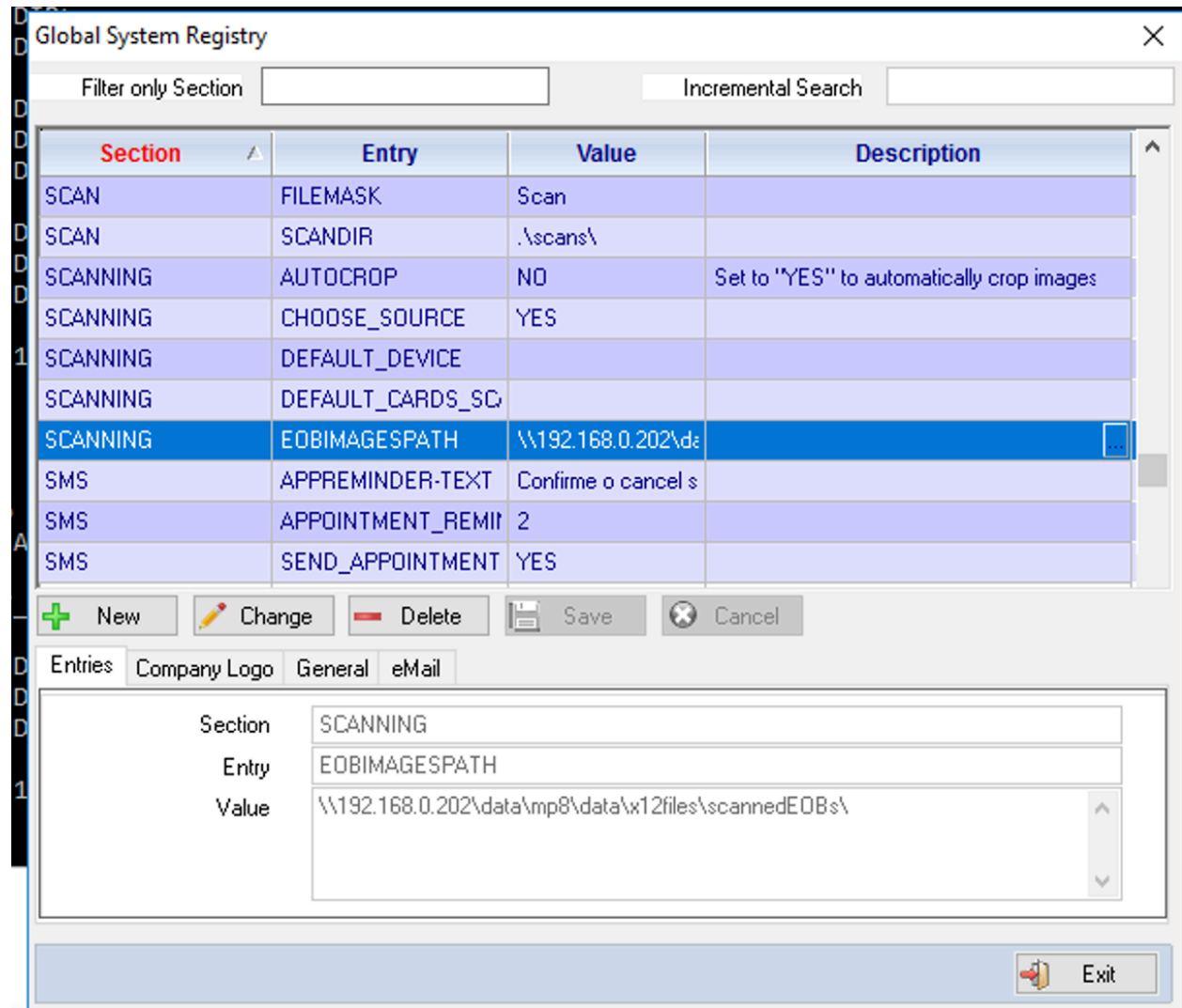


Figure 1: The Global System Registry in Admin10

Every setting has four parts:

Column	Meaning
Section	The group a setting belongs to, e.g. BACKUPS, SCANNING
Entry	The name of the setting, e.g. BACKUP_PATH
Value	What you are setting it to
Description	A free-text note for whoever reads it next

3.1 Adding or changing a setting

1. Open **Admin10** and go to the **Global System Registry**.

2. To find an existing setting, type into **Filter only Section** (for example BACKUPS) or use **Incremental Search**.
3. Press **New** to add a setting, or select a row and press **Change** to edit one.
4. Fill in **Section**, **Entry** and **Value** in the *Entries* tab at the bottom.
5. Press **Save**.

Type the Section and Entry names exactly as shown in this guide. They are matched by name. A misspelled entry is not an error — it is simply a setting nobody reads, so the feature stays switched off with no warning.

Settings are read when AutoTasks starts. **After changing anything in this guide, restart the AutoTasks service** so it picks up the new values. (*IT task.*)

4 Backups

AutoTasks can take an **Advantage Database Server hot backup** — a consistent copy of your live data taken while people are still working in Mp10 — and optionally compress it into a dated zip file, keeping only the most recent few.

4.1 Turning backups on

Backups run only when **all three** of these are set. Leave any one of them blank and no backup will ever run.

Entry	Example	What it means
BACKUP_PATH	\\adsserver\backup\mp10\	Where the backup image is written
BACKUP_TIMES	02:00:00	Earliest time of day the backup may start
BACKUP_DAYS	2345	Which days of the week it may run

All three go in section **BACKUPS**.

4.1.1 BACKUP_PATH — read this carefully

This is the one setting people most often get wrong.

The backup is written by the **Advantage Database Server**, not by Mp10 and not by your workstation. The path must therefore make sense *to the database server process*:

- **UNC paths work** — \\server\share\folder\
- **Local drive letters on the database server work** — D:\Backups\
- **Mapped network drives do NOT work** — Z:\Backups\ will fail, even if Z: is perfectly visible from your own PC

The account the Advantage service runs under must have permission to write there. (*IT task.*)

4.1.2 BACKUP_DAYS — the day codes

Days are given as a string of digits run together, one digit per allowed day:

Digit	Day
1	Sunday
2	Monday
3	Tuesday
4	Wednesday
5	Thursday
6	Friday
7	Saturday

So:

Value	Meaning
2345	Monday through Thursday

Value	Meaning
234567	Monday through Saturday
1234567	Every day
7	Saturdays only

4.1.3 BACKUP_TIMES

A 24-hour time, HH:MM:SS. 02:00:00 means “any time from 2 a.m. onward”.

Pick a time when the practice is quiet. A hot backup does not lock anybody out, but it does work the server hard.

A backup runs at most once per calendar day. If one has already been taken today, AutoTasks will not take another, however many times it wakes up.

4.2 Optional: zipping and retention

If you also set a zip path, AutoTasks compresses each backup into a dated archive and prunes old ones.

Entry	Example	Default	What it means
BACKUP_ZIP_PATH	D:\Backups\Zips\	<i>(blank)</i>	Where dated zips are written. Blank = do not zip
MAX_BACKUPS_TO_KEEP	20	20	How many zips to keep. Oldest beyond this are deleted
FILES_TO_SKIP	oldtable.adt;temp.adt	<i>(blank)</i>	Data files to leave out of the backup, separated by semicolons

Zip files are named by date, so they sort chronologically:

Mp10Data-2026-07-31.zip

Unlike BACKUP_PATH, the zip path is used by AutoTasks itself, so an ordinary path reachable from the Mp10 server is fine.

MAX_BACKUPS_TO_KEEP deletes files. Once the number of zips in BACKUP_ZIP_PATH exceeds this number, the oldest are erased automatically. Keep that folder for backups only, and set the number to match the disk space you have.

4.3 A working example

Section	Entry	Value
BACKUPS	BACKUP_PATH	\\adsserver\backup\mp10\
BACKUPS	BACKUP_TIMES	02:00:00
BACKUPS	BACKUP_DAYS	234567
BACKUPS	BACKUP_ZIP_PATH	D:\Backups\Zips\
BACKUPS	MAX_BACKUPS_TO_KEEP	30

This takes a backup Monday through Saturday, any time after 2 a.m., zips it to a local disk, and keeps the last 30 zips.

4.4 Backups are not a disaster recovery plan on their own

A backup that has never been restored is a hope, not a backup. Copy the zips off-site — or at minimum onto a different physical machine — and test a restore periodically. AutoTasks writes the file; making sure it survives a fire, a theft or a ransomware event is a decision only the practice can make.

5 Electronic remittances (EOB / ERA PDFs)

Insurers publish payment advices — remittance notices, ERAs, EOBs — to their provider portals as PDF files. AutoTasks can read those PDFs and post the payments into Mp10 automatically, so nobody has to key them in.

5.1 What you have to do

1. **Choose a folder** where remittance PDFs will be saved.
2. **Declare that folder** in the System Registry.
3. **Save PDFs into it** as you download them.

That is the whole workflow. Everything after step 3 is automatic.

5.2 Step 1 — Choose the folder

Any folder the Mp10 server can reach. A share on your file server is the usual choice, so that billing staff can drop files in from their own workstations.

Requirements:

- The AutoTasks service account needs permission to **read, write and delete** in it. It does not merely read the PDFs — it moves them when it is done.
- If more than one person will save files there, give them all write access.
- Do not point it at a folder used for anything else. AutoTasks processes and then moves *every* PDF it finds there.

5.3 Step 2 — Declare the folder

Section	Entry	Example value
SCANNING	EOBIMAGESPATH	\\192.168.0.202\data\mp8\data\x12files\sca

The screenshot in *Where settings live* shows exactly this entry being edited.

Setting this value is the on/off switch. There is no separate “enable” setting. If EOBIMAGESPATH has a value, remittance processing is on; if it is blank, it is off. Include the trailing backslash.

Restart the AutoTasks service after setting it. (*IT task.*)

5.4 Step 3 — Save your remittance PDFs there

Download the remittance PDF from your insurer’s portal as you normally would, and save it into the folder. Nothing else is required — you do not need to rename the file or record it anywhere.

Guidelines:

- **One remittance per PDF.** If the portal offers a combined download of many checks, prefer separate files.
- **Let the download finish before AutoTasks wakes up.** Saving directly into the watched folder over a slow connection can expose a half-written file. If that is a risk, save to your desktop and move the finished file in.
- **Do not put anything else in the folder.** Non-remittance PDFs will be read, found to contain nothing usable, and left behind.

5.5 What happens next

On its next wake-up, for each PDF in the folder, AutoTasks:

1. **Reads the PDF.** It first tries to read the text directly. If the PDF is a scan with no text in it, it falls back to optical character recognition.
2. **Writes a ..._eob.json file** beside the PDF holding what it found — the check number and date, the payee, and every claim and service line.
3. **Checks the remittance belongs to your practice** (see below).
4. **Posts the payments** into the remittances file, ready to be applied.
5. **Moves the PDF** into a **history** sub-folder so it is not processed twice:

```
...\scannedEOBs\history\C6472004.pdf
```

If you want to know what happened to a particular file, search `AutoTasks.out` for its name.

5.6 If your server serves more than one practice

A single AutoTasks server can serve several practices, each with its own data dictionary, all watching the same folder.

AutoTasks reads the **payee** — the provider the cheque was made out to — from each remittance and compares it against the NPIs and provider numbers registered for the practice it is currently connected to.

- If they **match**, the remittance is posted and the PDF is moved to **history**.
- If they **do not match**, the file is **left exactly where it is**, untouched, so the run connected to the practice that owns it can pick it up.

You do not need to sort remittances by practice, and nothing is lost if a file is downloaded into the wrong practice's queue.

If a remittance carries no identifiable payee at all, it is treated as yours and processed. Most payer layouts do print one; some do not.

5.7 What must be installed on the server

(IT task — but if remittances are not being read, this is the first thing to check.)

Component	Purpose	Registry setting
Python 3	Runs the extractor	GENERAL / PYTHONPATH — folder holding <code>python.exe</code> , with a trailing backslash
<code>extract_eob.py</code>	The extractor itself	Must sit in the same folder as the AutoTasks program
Poppler	Renders scanned PDFs to images	Installed at C:\Mp10\poppler\Library\bin
Tesseract OCR	Reads text out of scans	Installed at C:\Program Files\Tesseract-OCR

Poppler and Tesseract are needed **only for scanned remittances**. If your insurers all publish normal text PDFs, remittances will process without them.

A second log, `python_debug.log`, is written next to the AutoTasks program and holds the extractor's own output. It is the place to look if a specific PDF fails.

6 Automated reports

Any Mp10 report can be scheduled to run by itself and be e-mailed out. You set this up from the report itself, not from a central screen.

6.1 Setting up a report

Open the report you want as you normally would, set its parameters, then go to the **Automate Report** tab.

The screenshot shows the 'Unbilled Report Parameters' dialog box with the 'Automate Report' tab selected. The 'Automated Report Users' table lists 'RCB' with email 'reinaldo.crespo@gmail.com'. The 'Frequency' section has 'Daily' checked. The 'Weekly Frequency' section has 'Mondays' selected. The 'Scheduled Time' is set to '7:00:00 AM'. The 'Report Name' is 'Daily Unbilled Report'. The 'Send as PDF' checkbox is checked. The 'Run' and 'Exit' buttons are at the bottom right.

Figure 2: The Automate Report tab, here on the Unbilled Report

6.1.1 Who receives it

In **Automated Report Users**, press the green + and pick a user from the **RepUser** drop-down. Their e-mail address fills in beside them. Add as many recipients as you need; the red – removes the selected one.

The address comes from the user's Mp10 record. If it is wrong or missing, fix it on the user, not here.

6.1.2 When it runs

Tick one of the **Frequency** options:

Option	Runs
Daily	Every day
Weekly	Once a week, on the day you select on the right
First day of month	On the 1st

Option	Runs
Last day of month	On the last day of the month
End of Each Period	On your billing period's closing day
Suspend	Not at all — see below

Scheduled Date runs the report once, on that specific date, instead of repeating.

End of Each Period uses the day-of-month set in BILLING / DAYS_INTO_MONTH_BEFORE_CLOSING.

6.1.3 What time it runs

Scheduled Time sets the time of day. If you leave it blank the system default is used:

Setting	Section	Default
AUTO_REPORTS_TIME	AUTOTASKS	22:00:00

A report is only queued for a time that has not yet arrived today. If it is 3 p.m. and you schedule a daily report for 2 p.m., it will not run this afternoon — it starts tomorrow. When setting up a report you want to see today, pick a time that is still ahead of you, or use **Run** to produce it immediately.

6.1.4 What format it arrives in

Tick one or more of **Send as PDF**, **Send as XLS**, **Send as Fp3**, **Send as HTML**. PDF is the usual choice. XLS is worth ticking when the recipient will want to sort or total the figures themselves.

Report Pswrd puts a password on the attachment. Use it for anything leaving the practice.

6.1.5 Naming and saving

Give it a clear **Report Name** — this is what identifies the scheduled job and what recipients will see. **Daily Unbilled Report** is a better name than **report1**.

Press **Save Automated Report**. Press **Run** to test it right away without waiting for the schedule.

6.2 Stopping a report

Tick **Suspend** and save. The job stays configured, with its recipients and settings, but stops running. Untick it to resume.

This is preferable to deleting a report you may want back.

6.3 Making sure e-mail actually goes out

Scheduled reports are e-mailed through the practice's outgoing mail server. If that is not configured, reports will run and produce nothing anybody sees.

These live in section **eMail** (*IT task*):

Entry	Example	What it is
SMTP-ServerName	smtp.gmail.com	Outgoing mail server
SMTP-Port	465	Its port
SMTP-User	reports@yourpractice.com	Account used to send
SMTP-Pass	(password)	Its password

Entry	Example	What it is
Address	reports@yourpractice.com	Address messages come from
SMTP-Auth	YES	Whether the server requires a login
SENDMETHOD	CDO or SMTP	How mail is sent

If you use Gmail or Microsoft 365, an ordinary account password will not work. You need an app-specific password, and the account must permit it. This is the most common reason scheduled reports stop arriving after an otherwise unrelated IT change.

6.4 Keeping a copy on disk

To have every automated report also written to a folder — useful as an audit trail, or to feed a shared drive:

Section	Entry	Example
AUTOREPORTS	COPY_TO_PATH	\\fileserver\mp10\reports\

Leave it blank to skip.

7 Troubleshooting

Start with `AutoTasks.out`. Search it for the date you expected something to happen. Almost every question below is answered by a line in that file.

7.1 Nothing at all is happening

Check	How
Is the service running?	Windows Services , look for the Mp10 AutoTasks service (<i>IT task</i>)
Is it writing to the log?	Check the timestamp on <code>AutoTasks.out</code> — it should update every couple of minutes
Were settings changed and the service not restarted?	Restart it; settings are read at start-up

7.2 The backup never runs

Symptom	Likely cause
Nothing in the log about a backup	One of <code>BACKUP_PATH</code> , <code>BACKUP_TIMES</code> , <code>BACKUP_DAYS</code> is blank — all three are required
“Backup started” then an error	The path is not reachable <i>by the database server</i> . Check for a mapped drive letter; use UNC instead
Runs some days but not others	Check the digits in <code>BACKUP_DAYS</code> against the day-code table — 1 is Sunday, not Monday
Ran once, never again the same day	Working as designed — one backup per calendar day
Zips are disappearing	<code>MAX_BACKUPS_TO_KEEP</code> is pruning them. Raise it or move zips off elsewhere

7.3 Remittance PDFs are not being picked up

Symptom	Likely cause
Files sit in the folder, nothing in the log	<code>SCANNING / EOBIMAGESPATH</code> is blank or misspelled, or the service was not restarted
“belongs to another practice - left in place”	Working as designed — the cheque is payable to a different practice on this server
The file was read but no payments appeared	The claims on it could not be matched. The log names each claim it could not resolve
Log mentions the extractor failing	Look in <code>python_debug.log</code> . Usually Python or the extractor script is missing from the server
Only scanned remittances fail	Poppler or Tesseract is not installed

Once processed, the PDF is in the `history` sub-folder — it has not been lost.

7.4 A scheduled report did not arrive

Symptom	Likely cause
It never ran at all	Check Suspend is not ticked; check the frequency matches today
Set up today, did not run today	The scheduled time had already passed when you saved it — it starts tomorrow
Ran, but nobody received it	The eMail settings, most often an expired or non-app-specific password
One person did not get it	Their address on their user record, not on the report
Arrived empty	The report's own parameters — run it manually with Run and see

7.5 Getting help

When contacting support, having these ready will save a round trip:

- the relevant section of **AutoTasks.out**, covering the time in question
- **python_debug.log**, for remittance problems
- the exact Section and Entry values you have set
- for a remittance problem, the PDF itself

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